



1V1 ATTACKING

Taking players on

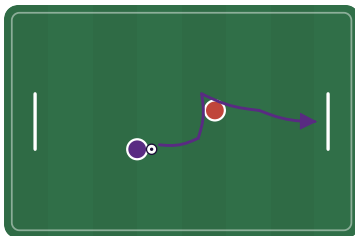
SESSION PLAN



WARM-UP · OPTIONAL Tails tag 10 min

Every player tucks a pinnie into the back of their shorts like a tail. On 'go', grab other players' tails without losing yours. Grab one, drop it, keep playing, count tails at the end. No ball, and keep it inside a marked square.

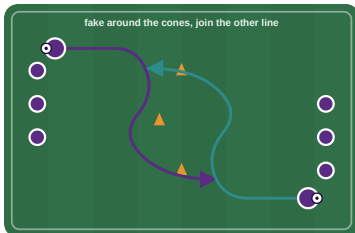
SAY IT SIMPLY "Grab a tail!" · "Protect yours!" · "Quick feet!"



PLAY 1v1 to small goals 15 min

Play this first, no coaching yet. Set two small goals about twelve yards apart. One attacker and one defender start level between them; the attacker tries to beat the defender and dribble through either goal. Rotate a fresh pair in after each turn so nobody waits long.

SAY IT SIMPLY "Be brave!" · "Take them on!" · "Try again!"



PRACTICE Two lines, fake the cones 15 min

Now teach it: this fixes what just came up in Play. Split into two lines facing each other, about fifteen yards apart, with three cones staggered down the middle. On 'go', the first player in each line dribbles toward the middle and uses a fake, lean one way, push the ball the other, to get around each cone, then joins the back of the opposite line. Send the next pair as soon as there's room.

SAY IT SIMPLY "Fake around the cone!" · "Head up!" · "Nice and controlled!"

PLAY Small-sided play 15 to 20 min

Bring the game back so it gets used. Even teams, 3v3 or 4v4 to small goals. Light coaching, let them play.

SAY IT SIMPLY "Take players on!"

WHY IT MATTERS

1v1 is the foundation of attacking play. The willingness to take a defender on is best built young. Frequent reps in a low-pressure setting let players try a move, lose the ball, and go again without penalty.

HOW IT DEVELOPS

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|------------------|---|
| U7 to U8 | Add a second move and a change of speed after beating the first defender, and attack 1v1 in tighter space. |
| U8 to U10 | 1v1 becomes a deliberate choice in wide areas. Players learn when to take a defender on and when to release the ball. |